

FILM DOSSIER: ANT-MAN AND THE WASP

Phase 1 · Film #4

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	4 of 29
Phase	Phase 1
Real title	<i>ANT-MAN AND THE WASP</i> (the heroes' billing in Tales to Astonish)
Decoy / codename title	"SUMMER PICNIC"
Release date	Friday, November 6, 2009
Distributor	Paramount Pictures
Director	Edgar Wright
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 142 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + sci-fi adventure at impossible scale, with a romantic-comedy spine

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	TYLER CHAPMAN (Ant-Man), sharing top billing with ELXA BULLOCK (the Wasp). It's the first MCU film with two heroes billed above the title.

Character	Actor	Age at release
Dr. Henry "Hank" Pym / Ant-Man	Tyler Chapman	27
Janet van Dyne / The Wasp	Elxa Bullock	29
Dr. Vernon van Dyne	Dennis Haysbert (<i>fresh casting</i>)	55
Elihas Starr / Egghead	Paul Giamatti (<i>fresh casting</i>)	42
Agent Jasper Sitwell	Maximiliano Hernández	35
Tony Stark (<i>cameo</i>)	Marc-Anthony Bullock	27
Stan Lee (<i>cameo: a picnicker who swats at a "very large ant"</i>)	Stan Lee	86

A family note for the mockumentary: Elxa's co-star in her cameo is her little brother.

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	<i>Tales to Astonish</i> #27 (January 1962), "The Man in the Ant Hill," by Stan Lee, Larry Lieber & Jack Kirby. <i>Tales to Astonish</i> #35 (September 1962): Ant-Man's costume and cybernetic helmet . <i>Tales to Astonish</i> #44 (June 1963), Lee, H.E. Huebner & Kirby: the Wasp's origin and her father's murder.
Supporting comics	<i>Tales to Astonish</i> #38 (1962, Egghead) · <i>Tales to Astonish</i> #44 (1963, Hank's late first wife, Maria Trovaya) · <i>The Avengers</i> #2 (1963, Giant-Man, teased in the mid-credit)
Nerf check	✓ When he shrinks, Ant-Man keeps his full human strength in an ant-sized body, which makes him stronger than anything his size. The Wasp's stings drop grown men.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	96% . It combines three origin issues. Every major beat comes from the page.

Straight from the page:

- **Hank shrinks himself with his new formula**, is trapped in an **anthill**, fights off soldier ants, and survives with help from a friendly ant (*TtA* #27).
- **The costume and the cybernetic helmet** let him **talk to and command ants** (*TtA* #35).
- **Hank is still grieving his first wife, Maria Trovaya**, a Hungarian scientist killed behind the Iron Curtain (*TtA* #44).
- **Dr. Vernon van Dyne**, a scientist in **Cresskill, New Jersey**, fires a gamma-beam signal into space to contact other worlds. It brings **an alien criminal from the planet Kosmos** to Earth, and it **kills him** (*TtA* #44).

- **Janet**, grieving and furious, asks Hank for help. He **grafts wasp cells** into her so that when she shrinks she **grows wings** (*TtA* #44).
- **Hank notices how much Janet looks like Maria**, and that complicates his feelings from the start (616).
- **Egghead**, the disgraced government scientist **Elihas Starr**, is Hank's **archenemy** (*TtA* #38).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| Egghead's role in bringing the Kosmosian to Earth | In 1962–63 they were separate villains. Combining them tightens the film, and each keeps their 616 personality. |

| The Wasp's stings come from bio-electric energy she generates herself | Early on she used a sting gun. We use the **later 616 version** of her powers, per the Bible's rule on using the latest 616 version of a detail. |

| Hank's age is 27 (b. **December 5, 1981**) | Matches Tyler |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Hank Pym	Genius biochemist; inventor of Pym Particles (<i>TtA</i> #27)	Invents the shrinking formula; designs the helmet; grafts the wasp cells	His growth formula (see the mid-credit scene)	✓ 100%
Ant-Man	Shrinks to insect size; keeps his full human strength at that size (punches like a man, hits like a bullet); commands ants with the cybernetic helmet; rides flying ants (<i>TtA</i> #35)	All of it: rides a carpenter ant through a ventilation duct, knocks out a gunman from inside his collar, sends a million-ant swarm against Egghead's lab	Giant-Man (616: <i>Avengers</i> #2). Held for the mid-credit scene and <i>The Avengers</i> .	✓ 100%
The Wasp	Shrinks and grows wasp wings for flight ; bio-electric stings ; very agile; tactical mind (<i>TtA</i> #44 on)	Flight through a thunderstorm, stings that knock out armed guards, air combat against the Kosmosian	Her later leadership of the Avengers	✓ 100%
Janet van Dyne	Heiress, fashion designer, fearless (<i>TtA</i> #44)	Designs her own and Hank's uniforms (616)	–	✓ 100%
Egghead	Criminal super-genius engineer (<i>TtA</i> #38)	Builds an ant-jamming frequency device and a gamma "cage" for the alien	–	✓ 100%
The Kosmosian	Alien fugitive; able to change its shape and density ; very strong (<i>TtA</i> #44)	Kills Vernon; fights the heroes at every size	–	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	A grieving scientist who can shrink to the size of an ant and a fearless heiress who wants revenge for her father become Earth's smallest heroes.
Theme	Size isn't power. Small people and small moments change the world. It's also about grief, and learning to love again.
Villain / antagonist	Egghead (Elihas Starr) and the Kosmosian

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: THE MAN IN THE ANT HILL

- **New York, Monday, June 8, 2009. Dr. Hank Pym**, 27, a brilliant biochemist, lives in his lab. He still wears his late wife **Maria's** wedding ring.
- The science world is buzzing about his "Pym Particles" paper, and Tony Stark called it "show-off" work in *Iron Man*.
- Testing the formula on himself, he **shrinks to half an inch**, gets knocked out a window, and ends up **inside an anthill**, where he's hunted by soldier ants and saved by one friendly one.
- He survives and gets obsessed. He builds a **cybernetic helmet** that talks to ants, and **Ant-Man** is born.

ACT TWO: THE WASP

- **Dr. Vernon van Dyne**, an astrophysicist in **Cresskill, New Jersey**, brings Hank in to consult on his project: **a gamma-beam signal to other worlds**.
- There Hank meets Vernon's daughter **Janet**, a quick, funny, fearless fashion designer (the woman Tony met at the Maria Stark Foundation gala). Hank is shaken. **She looks like Maria**.
- **Egghead**, Vernon's disgraced ex-partner, has been **boosting the signal** in secret. Something answers.
- **A creature from the planet Kosmos** comes through the beam and **kills Vernon**.
- Janet tells Hank she wants revenge and asks him to help her get it. Hank grafts **wasp cells** into her. She shrinks, **grows wings**, and **flies**.

ACT THREE: THE HIVE

- Egghead captures the Kosmosian in a gamma cage, plans to sell it as a weapon, and jams Hank's ant frequency.
 - **Ant-Man and the Wasp** team up for the first time. The fight moves up and down in scale across Egghead's Hudson River lab, and the Wasp wins the aerial fight in the rain.
 - The creature escapes and is sent back through the beam to Kosmos. Egghead is arrested, and he swears revenge.
 - Janet and Hank are sitting on the edge of a dollhouse roof, half an inch tall. She asks what they should call themselves. He says, "*Partners?*" She kisses him.
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5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, June 8, 2009 → Saturday, September 26, 2009. The post-credit scene is on Sunday, October 4, 2009.
Where it's set	New York City (Pym's lab, the Hudson River waterfront) · Cresskill, New Jersey (the van Dyne estate, filmed on location)
Relative to other films	Two months after <i>Thor</i>. A dent from Thor's lightning fight is still visible on the Brooklyn Bridge in one shot.

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **Pym Particles** and **the rules of size**: you keep your mass and strength, and it takes enormous amounts of energy.
- **The ant-helmet**, the **wasp-cell graft**, **Egghead**, and Janet's father's legacy.
- **The New York science scene**, where Pym and Stark are rivals.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
Tony Stark	A cameo: Tony turns up at Pym's lab offering to buy the Pym Particles patent, and Hank throws him out. TONY: "You know you could just say 'no thank you.'" HANK: "No thank you."	<i>The Avengers</i>
S.H.I.E.L.D.	Sitwell recovers the gamma-beam transmitter, which uses Desert Base technology.	<i>The Avengers</i>
Aliens are real	The first alien on Earth in the MCU	Phase 2, the cosmic side
Giant-Man	The mid-credit scene	<i>The Avengers</i> (616: <i>Avengers</i> #2)
"The Avengers"	The post-credit scene	<i>The Avengers</i> (Janet names the team)

Setting up the Big Bad

Seed	How it appears	What it means
The Kosmosian's fear	Before it's sent back, the creature shows Janet a mental image: a golden helmet, purple skin, a smile . It hisses, <i>"He takes the worlds that aren't looking."</i>	The first time the MCU's audience sees Thanos, for half a second
Earth is visible now	Vernon's gamma beam went into deep space	Earth has announced itself to the cosmos .

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	 "GROWING PAINS." Late at night in Pym's lab, Hank drinks a reversed-formula vial. He grows , fast, and his head goes through the ceiling. Janet looks up from her sketchbook, unimpressed. JANET: <i>"Now THAT'S a show-off."</i>
Post-credit scene	 "THE NAME." Janet's design studio. She's pinned newspaper clippings to her mood board: Iron Man, the Hulk, Thor , and a grainy shot of Ant-Man and the Wasp . She sketches a stylized "A" and taps her pencil against it. JANET (to herself): <i>"Somebody really ought to put all of you in one room."</i> CUT TO BLACK.
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: "ROOF REPAIR." Post-credit: "MOOD BOARD."

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline